When the number of women fighting for gender equality in the State of Israel was negligible, and the term *gender* was not yet in common use, the Mossad in general and the unit in particular implemented equality between the sexes on a practical level. Female employees and combatants of the Mossad have always filled the entire range of operational roles, including senior management positions and command of operations, with male subordinates working underneath them.

An issue that comes up as part of this discussion is what the required model of behavior should be between a male combatant and a female combatant when they work as part of the same team. There are those who say not to interfere. However, I believe that it is useful to set out certain guidelines, mainly because of one particular risk. If and when the relationship between two combatants becomes romantic or sentimental, there is a danger that their decisions, or that of the commander between the two, will no longer be the result of cold and clear judgment, and when this happens, mishaps occur.

I am not sure if I have fully succeeded in laying out the principles of compartmentalization that I believe in, but the cumulative sum of what I have said should provide a sketch of the figure of the combatant and make clear that what is required of her and what she does makes her someone of much higher caliber than the average person. Such was Sylvia, and so we will remember her. In her spirit we will train the next generations of combatants.

May her memory be a blessing.

For Leika, 30 Days after Her Passing, and for Moshe Levin ("Kokla") on the Seventeenth Anniversary of His Passing (September 19, 2011)

My last meeting with Leika was on a Friday afternoon, August 12, in the tiny room in the intensive care unit of Ichilov hospital's neurosurgical department. I have had quite a few difficult meetings in my life. This was one of the most difficult.

Leika lay in her bed, which took up most of the tiny room, and her expression was calm. Her speech was quiet and slow, but clear and razor-sharp. There were another three or four friends in the room. The